(intrasexual selection), but intersexual selection, where one sex (usually the female) makes the choice, was ridiculed.

Reproductive success is clearly essential for the future of a species. Natural selection is often described as “survival of the fittest,” but longevity alone is not particularly helpful. If individual A lives 10 times as long as individual B, but the latter produces twice as many offspring that then also breed, B will pass on more genes to the next generation than the longer-lived A.